HORIZONCARE

Example Policy Document

HorizonCare Silver PPO 2500

Effective Date	January 1, 2025
Document Version	v3.2
Applies To	In-network and out-of-network benefits unless otherwise stated.

1. Overview of Covered Benefits

This Policy provides coverage for Medically Necessary services that are not otherwise excluded. Covered Benefits include, but are not limited to:

- Physician office visits and specialist consultations
- Diagnostic imaging (e.g., ultrasound, CT, MRI)
- Outpatient procedures
- Emergency services
- Prescription drugs (Formulary-based)

Coverage is subject to member eligibility, cost-sharing, Prior Authorization requirements, and all limitations in this Policy.

2. Member Eligibility and Plan Status

Benefits are payable only if the member is enrolled and the Plan is active on the date of service.

If the member's Plan is inactive at the time services are rendered, the claim will be denied.

Denial reason: "Plan inactive at time of service."

3. Prior Authorization (Pre-Approval)

Prior Authorization is required for certain high-cost or high-risk services before they are performed.

3.1 Services Requiring Prior Authorization

The following services require Prior Authorization:

- MRI (all anatomical regions)
- CT scans (except emergency)
- Elective inpatient admissions
- Durable medical equipment (DME) exceeding $500
- Specialty drugs listed as "PA Required" on the Formulary

Claims for these services performed without approval may be denied unless retroactive authorization is granted.

3.2 Documentation Required

Prior Authorization requests must include:

1. Ordering provider's clinical note
2. Relevant diagnosis code(s)
3. Prior treatment history (if applicable)
4. Expected service date and location

If documentation is missing, the request will be pended until complete information is received.

4. Medical Necessity Standard

A service is considered Medically Necessary if it is:

- Consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice;
- Clinically appropriate in type, frequency, and setting;
- Not primarily for convenience of the member or provider;
- The most cost-effective option among clinically comparable alternatives.

Medical Necessity determinations may involve internal clinical guidelines.

5. Coverage for Diagnostic Imaging

5.1 MRI Coverage

MRI is covered when all of the following conditions are met:

- A covered diagnosis is present; and
- Conservative treatment has been attempted (unless contraindicated); and
- Prior Authorization has been approved.

Examples of covered diagnoses for lumbar spine MRI include:

- M54.5 Low back pain
- M51.26 Other intervertebral disc displacement, lumbar region

5.2 Non-Covered Imaging

Diagnostic imaging is not covered when:

- Requested for screening without symptoms, unless explicitly included as preventive care;
- Related to excluded procedures;
- Lacking documentation supporting Medical Necessity.

6. Exclusions

The Plan does not cover:

1. Cosmetic or reconstructive procedures not required by trauma or congenital anomaly
2. Services deemed not Medically Necessary
3. Experimental or investigational treatments
4. Services for which required Prior Authorization was not obtained
5. Duplicate claims for the same service date and provider, unless corrected and resubmitted

7. Claims Processing Rules

7.1 Duplicate Claims

A claim is considered duplicate if all of the following match:

- Member ID
- Provider NPI
- Date of service
- CPT / procedure code
- Billed amount

Duplicate claims will be denied with reason: “Duplicate claim submission.”

7.2 Coding Consistency

Claims may be routed for coding review if diagnosis and procedure codes are clinically inconsistent based on standard coding guidelines.

8. Appeals

Members and providers have the right to appeal a denial within 180 days.

Appeals must include:

- A written appeal request
- The denial letter or claim reference number
- Any new clinical documentation relevant to the denial reason

Appeals without new or relevant documentation may be upheld.

9. Contact Information

For questions about benefits, Prior Authorization, or claim status, contact HorizonCare Member Support at 1-800-555-0199 or via the Member Portal.